

Rome, Sweet Rome Continuation Program

Program Introduction

Rome, Sweet Rome begins with a modern American military force suddenly transported from Afghanistan to the Roman world in 23 BC. The Marines retain their people, weapons, vehicles, aircraft, equipment, medical knowledge, and modern education—but they lose contact with the modern world.

They cannot call for help. They cannot order replacement parts. Their fuel, ammunition, batteries, medicine, and packaged food are limited. Even powerful modern equipment will eventually break down or become unusable.

The Romans are not unintelligent or primitive. They possess an organized government, professional armies, roads, engineers, agriculture, trade networks, laws, religion, and political traditions. The modern force may be militarily superior in the beginning, but it is surrounded by a civilization containing millions of people.

The greatest challenge is therefore not simply defeating a Roman legion. The real challenge is deciding how the transported community will survive.

They must answer questions such as:

- How will they communicate with people who speak Latin?
- Should they cooperate with Augustus or remain independent?
- How will they produce food when their supplies run low?
- Which modern technologies can be reproduced using Roman tools?
- Who controls the transported community?
- Do American laws and military authority still apply?
- Should they attempt to change history?
- How should they respond to slavery, Roman religion, war, and political violence?
- What happens when their advanced weapons begin to fail?

The purpose of this program is to continue the story while respecting realistic limitations. The student may be imaginative, but every major decision should have a believable reason and a believable consequence.

The student does not need to calculate every gallon of fuel or every round of ammunition. The goal is to practice thoughtful storytelling, historical research, decision-making, and cause-and-effect reasoning.

Each assignment should be completed separately. Most assignments may be answered with a paragraph, a short list, a map, or a brief scene.

The final product will be an original continuation beginning with **Day 9**.

Taskings

Task 1: Read the Beginning

Read the available *Rome, Sweet Rome* story covering Days 1–8.

Write a short summary explaining:

- What happened
 - Who was transported
 - Where they arrived
 - What problems have already appeared
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Task 2: Identify the Immediate Problems

List the five most urgent problems facing the transported community.

Examples may include:

- Food
- Water
- Language
- Fuel
- Security
- Medicine
- Roman politics
- Internal discipline

Rank them from most urgent to least urgent.

Task 3: Choose the First Priority

Select the single problem that should receive the most attention on Day 9.

Explain:

- Why it is the most important problem
 - What the Marines should do
 - What could go wrong
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Task 4: Solve the Language Problem

Describe how the Marines and Romans begin learning to communicate.

Create a list of ten words or ideas they would need first.

Possible examples:

- Peace
 - Food
 - Water
 - Leader
 - Soldier
 - Friend
 - Enemy
 - Trade
 - Rome
 - America
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Task 5: Meet the Romans

Write a short scene showing the first serious diplomatic meeting between the Marines and Roman representatives.

The scene should include:

- Confusion caused by the language barrier
 - One misunderstanding
 - One successful exchange of information
 - A decision about what happens next
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Task 6: Protect Limited Resources

Choose three modern resources that must be carefully preserved.

For each resource, explain:

- Why it is valuable
 - How quickly it might run out
 - What could replace it, if anything
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Task 7: Choose What Technology to Share

Select one modern idea that could realistically be introduced to the Romans.

Examples include:

- Improved sanitation
- Germ theory
- Printing
- Better farming methods
- Concrete improvements
- Basic electricity
- Medical procedures

Explain the benefits and possible dangers of sharing it.

Task 8: Make a Government Decision

Decide how the transported community will be governed.

Possible choices include:

- Continue under military command
- Create an elected civilian council
- Divide authority between military and civilian leaders
- Cooperate directly with Augustus
- Establish an independent settlement

Explain why the chosen system might work.

Task 9: Face a Moral Problem

Choose one difficult issue:

- Roman slavery
- Religious differences
- Political executions
- Conquest
- Changing future history
- Using modern weapons against ancient soldiers

Explain what the Marines should do and why.

Task 10: Write Day 9

Write the next chapter of the story.

The chapter should include:

- One major decision
 - One interaction with the Romans
 - One resource problem
 - One unexpected consequence
 - One new problem leading into Day 10
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Task 11: Review the Consequences

After writing Day 9, answer:

- What improved?
 - What became worse?
 - What resources were used?
 - Who gained or lost trust?
 - What must be solved next?
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Task 12: Continue the Campaign

Repeat the following process for each new chapter:

1. Identify the main problem.
2. Choose a response.
3. Write what happens.
4. Describe the consequences.
5. Introduce the next problem.

The story may continue for ten days, one year, or several generations.

Dashboard Tracking

The developmental dashboard only needs to record:

- Task completed
- Date completed
- Effort level
- Main lesson learned

- Next task
- Optional parent or mentor comment

The dashboard does not need to simulate every military resource. The student's written decisions and explanations are the primary work.

Final Project

At the end of the program, the student should produce one of the following:

- A complete short story
- A series of connected chapters
- A comic or illustrated story
- A tabletop campaign
- A video presentation
- A simple computer simulation
- An alternate-history timeline

The central rule remains:

Be creative, but explain how each decision affects what happens next.